

INTERNATIONAL news

China unveils world's first 10G broadband network in Hebei

China has launched the world's first 10G broadband network in Sunan County, powered by Huawei and China Unicom. Offering download speeds of nearly 9834Mbps and upload speeds of 1008Mbps, this network uses 50G passive optical technology. It enables advanced applications like 8K streaming, virtual reality, and smart farming, positioning China as a global leader in broadband innovation.

Tariffs loom over chip sector as US probe comment window closes

The US may impose steep tariffs on imported semiconductors due to low public feedback during the Section 232 investigation, raising concerns over global supply chain disruptions. Tariffs of 25-100% could target chips based on manufacturing location, impacting Taiwan's TSMC and prompting shifts to South Korea or Japan. Industry experts warn of potential market consequences.

Samsung and Micron exit DDR4 and Taiwan steps in

Samsung and Micron are phasing out legacy DDR4 production with Samsung halting 8GB modules and Micron reducing DDR4 server module output. This shift reflects the industry's move toward DDR5 and HBM technologies. As supply tightens, Taiwanese suppliers like Nanya Technology and Winbond stand to benefit. DRAM pricing remains volatile, with an uncertain long-term outlook.

Intel to cut over 20% of jobs amid restructuring under new CEO

Intel is reportedly set to cut over 20% of its workforce immediately as part of a restructuring led by new CEO Lip-Bu Tan. The move aims to reduce bureaucracy and revitalise its engineering culture. With declining sales and competition from AI chipmakers like Nvidia, Intel seeks to streamline operations and focus on core technologies.

TSMC posts 22% gain in April amid semiconductor boom

TSMC reported a 22.2% MoM revenue surge in April 2025, reaching NT\$349.57 billion, driven by rising demand for advanced semiconductors. The company's cumulative revenue from January to April grew 43.5%, solidifying its leadership with a 67.1% market share. Analysts predict continued sector expansion, supported by AI chip demand and global initiatives.

STMicroelectronics sees Q2 recovery after weak start to 2025

STMicroelectronics reported Q1 2025 revenues of \$2.52 billion, meeting expectations despite a downturn. Net income fell to \$56 million with a gross margin of 33.4%. The company forecasts improved Q2 performance, projecting \$2.71 billion in revenue. STMicro is focusing on innovation and cost reduction, optimistic about a cyclical recovery in the industrial chip market.

Samsung's HARMAN acquires Masimo's consumer audio unit with \$350 million deal

Masimo Corporation has agreed to sell its consumer audio division, Sound United, to HARMAN International, a subsidiary of Samsung Electronics, for \$350 million. The sale, part of Masimo's strategy to refocus on healthcare, includes brands like Bowers

& Wilkins and Denon. The deal is expected to close by 2025, expanding HARMAN's audio portfolio.

AMD to begin US production of chips at TSMC's Arizona plant

Advanced Micro Devices (AMD) will begin producing key processor chips at TSMC's new Arizona facility, marking its first US-based manufacturing. This move, driven by geopolitical tensions, strengthens AMD's domestic supply chain. CEO Lisa Su also confirmed AMD's acquisition of AI server supplier ZT Systems. The shift aligns with AMD's focus on boosting US manufacturing capabilities.

Cadence to acquire ARM's Artisan IP business in strategic expansion

Cadence has agreed to acquire ARM's Artisan foundation IP business, including standard cell libraries and memory compilers. This acquisition strengthens Cadence's design IP portfolio and enhances its presence in system-on-chip designs. It aims to optimise power, performance, and cost across top-tier foundries. The deal, set to close in Q3 2025, also includes a technology license agreement.

Tesla sales plummet in Europe amid political backlash and rising competition

Tesla's sales dropped significantly across Europe in April, with declines exceeding 70% in Sweden, Denmark, and the Netherlands, and 59% in France. This follows CEO Elon Musk's controversial political involvement and production halts. Analysts point to factors like ageing models and Chinese competition. Despite a modest increase in Italy, Tesla faces uncertain prospects.

Infineon and Marelli launch advanced cockpit display tech at Auto Shanghai

Infineon Technologies and Marelli have introduced an automotive display system using MEMS laser beam scanning technology. Presented at Auto Shanghai 2025, this innovation offers flexible, immersive cockpit designs with low energy use and high efficiency. The system meets ASIL-B standards and provides clear visuals under bright light, enhancing automotive interior experiences.

Indium and Rio Tinto forge path for gallium sustainability

Indium Corporation and Rio Tinto have achieved a breakthrough in extracting gallium from Rio Tinto's Vaudreuil alumina refinery in Quebec, Canada. This collaboration aims to establish a stable North American supply of gallium, vital for semiconductors and tech products. The project will reach a 40-ton annual capacity, potentially meeting 10% of global demand.

EU and Japan agree to strengthen semiconductor tech ties

The European Union and Japan have agreed to enhance semiconductor research collaboration, aiming to strengthen supply chain resilience and share information. This partnership, announced at the Digital Partnership Council in Tokyo, extends to AI, cybersecurity, and quantum computing. The move aims to secure technological leadership, with Japan's semiconductor industry showing signs of revival.